

# Ready for the BIG STAGE

Five players from **Associate nations** who promise to deliver this World Cup.

The expanded field at this edition of the T20 World Cup offers Associate nations, including debutant Italy as well as the USA, the Netherlands and Scotland, all of whom have impressed at recent ICC events, a chance to reinforce their credentials as genuine upset threats. ICC tournaments also provide a crucial platform for players to showcase their quality, a factor made even more significant by the rapid growth of franchise opportunities across global cricket. Strong performances in major ICC events can bring Associate players to the attention of franchise owners, with potentially meaningful financial implications.

By Aditya Padinjat

## ■ Andries Gous



**Leading the charge for the USA will be Andries Gous, a powerful opening batter with an impressive record across the globe.** Gous' cricketing journey began in South Africa, where he represented the Under-19 side and played First-Class cricket, before relocating in 2021.

He first entered the reckoning for international honours ahead of the 2024 T20 World Cup, making an immediate impression on debut against Canada just over a month before the tournament.

Gous went on to score 219 runs across the competition at an average of 43.80 and a strike rate of 151.03. The standout moment was a stunning unbeaten 80 against his country of birth, an innings that threatened to carry his side to a famous victory.

Since then, Gous has built a creditable international record, representing the USA 25 times in T20Is and scoring 751 runs at an average of 32.65 and a strike rate of 145.26. He has also had a globetrotting 2025, with stints in the ILT20 (Abu Dhabi Knight Riders and Desert Vipers), the CPL (Antigua and Barbuda Falcons), the PSL (Islamabad United) and Major League Cricket (Washington Freedom).



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